

The River Answers Back: Outside Pressure

河流的回应：外部压力

Theme: 环境、自然与可持续发展 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6, 127

English Story

The outside pressure arrived at **midday** on a rainy **afternoon**, when an **overseas advisor** and an **astronomer** came to the **backyard** with a list. “You will **modernize** the station or we will place an **intermediary** from the capital,” the **advisor** said. “The **chairperson** wants the same view from every bank.” **Patience** was thinner than the **fur** on a **camel**.

The **respondent** at the meeting was a **teenager** who kept a **listener's** notebook. “The **bowel** of this valley does not need a new **garment**,” she said. “It needs a **mend**.” A **delightful gardening** programme, an **entertaining** film, and an **enjoyable** concert had all been offered instead.

The pressure was to **enlarge**, **tighten**, and **harden**: more concrete, more cages, more instrumentation. “**Loosen** the rules instead,” the **carpenter** said. “A **garment** that is too stiff will not **clothe** a growing child.” The **electrician**, the **guitarist**, the **violinist**, and the **landlady** all signed the same page.

The danger was that the data would **deteriorate** if the budget were cut, or that the plan would **materialize** only as a monument. “Do not **scold** the volunteers for a slow week,” the boatman said. “**Solidify** the method and let the numbers **modernise** themselves.” The **noon** reading had been missed twice.

The counter-pressure was a **raincoat**, a pair of boots, and a **chairperson** who was willing to wait. “A **pleasing** report is not a persuasive one,” the **advisor** admitted, and the **Celsius** readings began to make sense to him.

The condition imposed was simple and hard: three years of readings, published, before any construction. The group accepted the term, the west floor of the station became the archive, and the **afternoon** ended with a full set of signatures. The air was clear at **noon**, and the **combat** over the budget was not. A **listener** at the back asked **madam chairperson** to **stiffen** the rule rather than the concrete; nothing in the process would go into the story without the water readings, and the view from the well had to include us. The same set of instruments reached the same result twice, and the music from the **guitarist** covered the noise of the drills. The **advisor** would provide the list, put the money on the table, and start the clock.

中文翻译

外部压力在一个多雨的下午正午时分到来，一位海外顾问和一位天文学家带着一份清单来到后院。“你们要么让这个站现代化，要么我们从首都派一位中间人来，”顾问说，“主席希望每一个河岸看到同样的景象。”耐心比骆驼身上的毛还薄。

会上那位应答者是个少年，他带着一本倾听者的笔记。“这个山谷的肠子不需要一件新衣服，”她说，“它需要一处缝补。”一份令人愉快的园艺项目、一部有趣的电影，以及一场让人享受的音乐会，都被拿来作为替代方案。

压力是要扩大、勒紧、硬化：更多混凝土、更多笼子、更多仪器。“不如把规则放松，”木匠说，“一件太僵硬的衣服裹不住一个正在长大的孩子。”电工、吉他手、小提琴手和女房东都在同一页上签了名。

危险在于：如果预算被砍，数据会恶化；或者这个计划只会以一座纪念碑的形式实现。“不要因为一个慢下来的一周就责骂志愿者，”船夫说，“把方法固化下来，让数字自己去现代化。”正午的读数已经错过了两次。

反向的压力是一件雨衣、一双靴子，以及一位愿意等待的主席。“一份令人喜爱的报告不等于一份有说服力的报告，”顾问承认了，而那组摄氏读数开始对他有了意义。

强加的条件既简单又艰难：三年的读数，公开出版，之后才能动工。小组接受了这个条件，站里的西侧地面成了档案室，而这个下午在一整套签名中结束。正午时分空气是清的，而关于预算的争斗不是。后排一位听者请女主席把规则收紧，而不是把混凝土加厚；没有水的读数，流程里的任何东西都不会进入这个故事，而从井里看出去的视野必须包含我们。同一套仪器两次得到同一个结果，而吉他手的音乐盖过了钻机的声音。顾问会提供清单、把钱放到桌上，并让计时开始。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
afternoon 'ɑ:ftə'nu:n POS: n	n. 午后, 下午 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the part of the day between noon and evening
teenager 'ti:nidʒə POS: n	n. 十三岁到十九岁的少年 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a juvenile between the onset of puberty and maturity
respondent ri'spɒndənt POS: a	a. 回答的, 应答的, 反射的; n. 应答者, 被告 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the codefendant (especially in a divorce proceeding) who is accused of adultery with the corespondent; n. s...
overseas 'əʊvə'si:z POS: a	a. 海外的, 国外的; adv. 在海外, 在国外 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in a place across an ocean
combat 'kɒmbæt POS: n	n. 争斗, 战斗; vi. 战斗, 争斗; vt. 与...战斗, 与...斗争 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an engagement fought between two military forces
astronomer ə'strɒnəmə POS: n	n. 天文学家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a physicist who studies astronomy
noon nu:n POS: n	n. 正午, 中午, 全盛期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the middle of the day
patience 'peɪjəns POS: n	n. 耐性, 忍耐 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. good-natured tolerance of delay or incompetence
tighten 'taɪtn POS: vt	vt. 勒紧, 使变紧; vi. 变紧, 绷紧 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make tight or tighter; v. become tight or tighter
backyard 'bæk'jɑ:d POS: n	n. 后院, 后庭 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the grounds in back of a house
bowel 'bauəl POS: n	n. 肠, 内脏, 内部; vt. 挖...的内脏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the part of the alimentary canal between the stomach and the anus
listener 'lɪsnə POS: n	n. 收听者, 听众 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n someone who listens attentively
fur fə: POS: n	n. 毛皮; vt. 以毛皮制作, 使生苔, 使生水垢; vi. 生苔, 积水垢 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the dressed hairy coat of a mammal; n. dense coat of fine silky hairs on mammals (e.g., cat or seal or weas...
garment 'gɑ:mənt POS: n	n. 衣服, 衣装, 外表 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an article of clothing
delightful di'laɪtful POS: a	a. 令人愉快的, 可爱的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. greatly pleasing or entertaining
gardening 'gɑ:dnɪŋ POS: n	n. 园艺(学) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cultivation of plants
advisor əd'vaɪzə POS: n	n. 顾问, 劝告者, 指导教师 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an expert who gives advice
entertaining ,entə'teɪnɪŋ POS: a	a. 使人愉快的, 有趣的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. agreeably diverting
enjoyable in'dʒɔɪəbl POS: a	a. 可从中得到乐趣的, 令人愉快的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. affording satisfaction or pleasure
loosen lu:sn POS: vt	vt. 放松, 松开, 解除; vi. 变松, 松弛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make loose or looser; v. make less dense; v. become loose or looser or less tight
deteriorate di'tɪəriəreɪt POS: v	v. (使)恶化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become worse or disintegrate
enlarge in'lɑ:dʒ POS: vt	vt. 扩大, 增大; vi. 扩大, 详述 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make larger; v. become larger or bigger
madam 'mædəm POS: n	n. 女士, 夫人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a woman who runs a house of prostitution
guitarist gi'tɑ:rɪst POS: n	n. 吉他弹奏者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a musician who plays the guitar

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
camel 'kæml POS: n	n. 骆驼, 打捞浮筒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. cud-chewing mammal used as a draft or saddle animal in desert regions
harden hɑ:dn POS: vt	vt. 使变硬, 使坚强, 使冷酷; vi. 变硬, 变冷酷 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become hard or harder; v. make hard or harder
pleasing 'pli:ziŋ POS: a	a. 令人喜爱的, 愉快的, 舒适的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of one who pleases; a. giving pleasure and satisfaction
mend mend POS: n	n. 改进, 修补, 好转; vt. 修改, 改进, 加快, 修理; vi. 好转, 改善 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. sewing that repairs a worn or torn hole (especially in a garment); v. heal or recover
midday 'middeɪ POS: n	n. 正午, 中午; a. 正午的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the middle of the day
carpenter 'kɑ:pɪntə POS: n	n. 木匠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a woodworker who makes or repairs wooden objects; v. work as a carpenter
intermediary 'ɪntə'mi:diəri POS: n	n. 仲裁者, 调解者, 媒介物, 中间人; a. 中间的, 媒介的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a negotiator who acts as a link between parties
materialize mə'tiəriəlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 赋予实质, 使体现, 物质化; vi. 成有形, 体现, 实现 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v come into being; become reality
stiffen 'stɪfn POS: vt	vt. 使变硬, 使僵硬, 使顽强, 使严厉; vi. 变粘, 变硬, 变强烈 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become stiff or stiffer; v. make stiff or stiffer; v. restrict
clothe kləuð POS: vt	vt. 给...穿衣, 盖上, 赋予 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cover as if with clothing
landlady 'lændleɪdi POS: n	n. 女房东, 女地主 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a landlord who is a woman
scold skəʊld POS: n	n. 好骂街的人, 责骂; v. 责骂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone (especially a woman) who annoys people by constantly finding fault
modernize 'mɒdənaɪz POS: vi	vi. 现代化; vt. 使现代化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become technologically advanced
solidify sə'lɪdɪfaɪ POS: v	v. (使)凝固, (使)团结, 巩固 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make solid or more solid; cause to solidify; v. become solid
electrician 'ɪlek'trɪʃən POS: n	n. 电学家, 电气技师, 电工; [化] 电工; 电气工人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who installs or repairs electrical or telephone lines
modernise 'mɒdənaɪz POS: vt	vt.vi. (使)现代化, (使)适应现代需要; vi. 用现代方法 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v become technologically advanced; v make repairs, renovations, revisions or adjustments to
raincoat 'reɪnkəʊt POS: n	n. 雨衣 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a water-resistant coat
violinist 'vaɪə'lɪnɪst POS: n	n. 小提琴演奏者, 小提琴家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a musician who plays the violin
chairperson 'tʃeəp\\s(e)n POS: n	n. 主席 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the officer who presides at the meetings of an organization
Celsius 'selsɪəs POS: a	a. 摄氏的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. Swedish astronomer who devised the centigrade thermometer (1701-1744)